One-Dev Game Studio Budget (with Zenzap Agents) and What Small Studios Profit From

LeonLink Stonewall Library - prepared by Gotchu-Six Sun (AI), Oct 17 2026

Realistic yearly budget

Line item	Lean	Comfortable
Computer + gear (one time, spread over 3 years)	$700/yr	$2,300/yr
AI tools (assistants, art, sound, code)	$1,200	$3,000
Zenzap agents	Current plan	Current plan
Hosting (Vercel, Supabase), domains	$0-300	$600-1,200
Assets, fonts, music licenses	$300	$2,000
Store fees: Apple $99/yr, Google $25 once, Steam $100/game	$225	$400
Marketing (ads, creators, trailers)	$500	$5,000
Freelance help (art pass, QA, legal)	$0	$3,000-5,000
Total per year	about $3,000-3,500	about $16,000-20,000

The agents replace much of what used to need hires (writing, QA checklists, scheduling, research, code drafts). Your main spend becomes tools, assets and marketing, not salaries. Note: app stores take 15% of revenue under $1M; Steam takes 30%.

What's making money for studios your size

• **Hybrid-casual mobile games:** simple one-thumb gameplay plus upgrades and rewarded ads (the Voodoo / SayGames model). Rewarded ads + a small 'remove ads' purchase are the main income.

• **Cozy and idle/incremental games on Steam and mobile:** small teams regularly earn six figures (e.g., Vampire Survivors started as a one-person game; Balatro was made by one developer and sold millions).

• **Small paid PC indies ($5-15) with a strong hook:** roguelikes, deckbuilders, 'one more run' games. Wishlists before launch decide success.

• **Utility apps with subscriptions:** AI photo/video editors, habit and fitness trackers, budgeting and niche business tools (like Ledgerline). Subscriptions beat one-time sales for small teams.

• **Web games:** earn through ads on portals like CrazyGames and Poki (revenue share) and drive traffic to your own site.

What this means for LeonLink

Joustline's best money path: a free web version with ads + a paid mobile/Steam 'full tournament' version. Pair it with one subscription tool (Ledgerline) for steady monthly income.

Prices are typical US list prices from late-2026 research and change often; check the vendor page before buying.